

Author purpose - Workbook 2

Focused practice - Workbook 2 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each text closely. Decide what relationship the question is testing before looking at the options. After checking the key, explain why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Before you start

- Use the surrounding text, not one isolated keyword.
- Prefer precise relationship words such as illustrates, qualifies, contrasts, supports, or results in.
- Do not accept an answer that merely summarizes when the question asks about function or effect.

Workshop Memo

A staff memo announces that the equipment workshop has moved from Friday to Thursday and explains that the change avoids a conflict with building maintenance.

1. What is the author's primary purpose?

- A. inform staff about a schedule change and explain why it was made
- B. to entertain readers with an unrelated story
- C. to describe the topic without giving readers a specific understanding or action
- D. to prove a stronger claim than the passage supports

2. Why is this kind of detail useful to the author's purpose?

- A. It changes the subject instead of supporting the purpose.
- B. The maintenance conflict gives the reason for changing the day.
- C. It provides a fact unrelated to what readers need to understand.
- D. It replaces the need for the rest of the passage.

Historic Steps

A preservation group asks the council to repair the stone steps at an old market rather than replace them with concrete. The letter describes their age, craftsmanship, and role in the original design.

3. What is the author's primary purpose?

- A. to entertain readers with an unrelated story
- B. to describe the topic without giving readers a specific understanding or action
- C. persuade the council to preserve and repair the historic steps
- D. to prove a stronger claim than the passage supports

4. Why is this kind of detail useful to the author's purpose?

- A. It changes the subject instead of supporting the purpose.
- B. It provides a fact unrelated to what readers need to understand.
- C. It replaces the need for the rest of the passage.
- D. The details about age and craftsmanship support the claim that the steps have historic value.

Storm Preparedness

A public-safety page tells residents to charge phones, store drinking water, secure outdoor objects, and learn the nearest shelter location before a tropical storm.

5. What is the author's primary purpose?

- A. instruct residents on practical actions to take before a storm
- B. to entertain readers with an unrelated story
- C. to describe the topic without giving readers a specific understanding or action
- D. to prove a stronger claim than the passage supports

6. Why is this kind of detail useful to the author's purpose?

- A. It changes the subject instead of supporting the purpose.
- B. The action list turns general preparedness into specific steps readers can follow.
- C. It provides a fact unrelated to what readers need to understand.
- D. It replaces the need for the rest of the passage.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A. Inform staff about a schedule change and explain why it was made.
2. B. The maintenance conflict gives the reason for changing the day.
3. C. Persuade the council to preserve and repair the historic steps.
4. D. The details about age and craftsmanship support the claim that the steps have historic value.
5. A. Instruct residents on practical actions to take before a storm.
6. B. The action list turns general preparedness into specific steps readers can follow.

Mistake review

- If you summarized instead of explaining a relationship, label it summary-not-function.
- If you chose a transition or structure because of one keyword, label it one-clue trap.
- If you confused a quoted perspective with the author's own view, label it viewpoint source.
- If you named a rhetorical device but missed what it achieves, label it effect missed.
- Redo missed questions later without looking at the key.